

CHAPTER 11

Google Keyword Planner (Complete Masterclass)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Understand what Google Keyword Planner is.
 - Learn how it works.
 - Understand every feature in detail.
 - Learn how to perform keyword research.
 - Interpret search volume, competition, and CPC.
 - Find the right keywords for SEO and PPC.
 - Use Keyword Planner for real-world projects.
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Topic 1: What is Google Keyword Planner?

Definition

Google Keyword Planner (GKP) is a free keyword research tool provided by **Google Ads**. It helps users discover keyword ideas, estimate search demand, analyze competition, and plan advertising campaigns.

Although it was originally created for advertisers, SEO professionals also use it to identify keywords that users search for on Google.

Why is Google Keyword Planner Important?

Imagine you are writing an article about Artificial Intelligence.

Without keyword research, you may choose a topic that very few people search for.

Google Keyword Planner helps answer questions like:

- What are people searching for?
 - How many times is a keyword searched each month?
 - How competitive is it?
 - Which related keywords should I target?
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Real-Life Example

Suppose you own an online bakery.

Instead of guessing whether people search for:

- Cakes
- Birthday Cakes
- Chocolate Cake Delivery

You use Keyword Planner to discover which keywords are searched more frequently and which ones have better opportunities.

Topic 2: Why Was Google Keyword Planner Created?

Google Ads needs to help advertisers choose the right keywords for their ads.

For example:

A shoe company wants to advertise running shoes.

Instead of selecting random keywords, Google Keyword Planner provides:

- Search demand
- Competition level
- Suggested bid estimates (CPC)
- Related keyword ideas

SEO professionals use this information to create content that targets popular searches.

Topic 3: How Google Keyword Planner Works

The process is simple.

User Enters a Keyword



Google Searches Its Database



Related Keywords Are Generated



Google Calculates:

- Search Volume
- Competition
- CPC
- Trends



Results Are Displayed

Topic 4: Accessing Google Keyword Planner

To use Google Keyword Planner:

1. Create or sign in to a Google account.
2. Access Google Ads.
3. Open the **Tools** menu.
4. Select **Keyword Planner**.

There are two main options:

- **Discover New Keywords**
- **Get Search Volume and Forecasts**

These are the core features of the tool.

Topic 5: Discover New Keywords

What Does It Do?

This feature generates keyword ideas based on:

- A word or phrase
- A website
- A category

It helps you expand your list of keywords.

Example

You enter:

Python

Google Keyword Planner may suggest:

Keyword

Python Tutorial

Learn Python

Python Programming

Python Course

Python Basics

Python Interview Questions

Python Certification

This saves time because you don't have to brainstorm every variation manually.

Topic 6: Search by Website

Instead of entering a keyword, you can enter a website URL.

Example:

www.example.com

Google analyzes the content of the website and suggests relevant keywords.

Why Is This Useful?

You can:

- Analyze your own website.
 - Find keywords relevant to a competitor's website.
 - Discover additional keyword opportunities.
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Topic 7: Get Search Volume and Forecasts

This feature is useful when you already have a list of keywords.

Instead of generating ideas, it provides detailed statistics.

Example:

You enter:

- Python
- Machine Learning
- AI

Google returns:

- Search volume
 - Competition
 - CPC estimates
 - Forecasts
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Topic 8: Understanding Search Volume

Search Volume is the estimated number of monthly searches for a keyword.

Example:

Keyword	Monthly Searches
Python	500,000
Python Tutorial	120,000
Learn Python	45,000

This helps determine how popular a keyword is.

Important Note

Google Keyword Planner often displays search volume as a **range** (for example, **10K–100K**) for many accounts, especially those without active advertising campaigns. Accounts with active Google Ads campaigns may receive more detailed estimates.

Topic 9: Understanding Competition

Competition measures **how many advertisers are bidding** on a keyword in Google Ads.

It does **not** measure SEO ranking difficulty.

Competition Levels

Competition	Meaning
Low	Few advertisers are bidding
Medium	Moderate advertiser competition
High	Many advertisers are bidding

Example

Keyword	Competition
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Python Basics	Low
Online MBA	High
Car Insurance	High

High advertiser competition often indicates strong commercial value.

Topic 10: Understanding CPC (Cost Per Click)

CPC is the estimated amount advertisers pay for a click on their ad.

Example

Keyword	CPC
Python Tutorial	₹10
Car Insurance	₹200
MBA Admission	₹150

Why is "Car Insurance" more expensive?

Because businesses earn significant revenue from insurance customers and are willing to pay more for qualified traffic.

Why Should SEO Professionals Care About CPC?

High CPC can indicate that:

- Businesses consider the keyword valuable.
 - Users searching for it may have purchase intent.
 - The topic may have good commercial potential.
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Topic 11: Keyword Filters

Google Keyword Planner provides filters to narrow results.

Common filters include:

- Country
 - Language
 - Search Network
 - Date Range
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Example

If your website targets users in India, select:

Country:

India

This ensures that the search data is relevant to your audience.

Topic 12: Keyword Sorting

You can sort keywords by:

- Search Volume
- Competition
- CPC
- Alphabetical Order

Sorting helps identify the best opportunities more efficiently.

Topic 13: Choosing the Right Keywords

Many beginners select only the highest-volume keyword.

This is often a mistake.

Instead, evaluate keywords using multiple factors:

Factor	Why It Matters
Search Volume	Indicates popularity
Competition	Shows advertiser demand
Search Intent	Ensures relevance
CPC	Indicates commercial value
Relevance	Matches your content

Example

Suppose you have two keywords:

Keyword	Volume	Competition
Python	High	High
Learn Python for Beginners	Medium	Low

For a new website, the second keyword is often a better choice because it has clearer intent and may be easier to target.

Topic 14: Keyword Forecasts

Google Keyword Planner can estimate advertising performance.

Forecasts may include:

- Estimated clicks
- Estimated impressions
- Estimated cost
- Estimated conversions (for ads)

These forecasts are designed for advertising campaigns but can also help understand keyword potential.

Topic 15: Practical Keyword Research Example

Suppose you are creating a blog about **Machine Learning**

Step 1: Enter the Seed Keyword

Machine Learning

Step 2: View Suggested Keywords

Google may suggest:

- Machine Learning Tutorial
 - Machine Learning Course
 - Machine Learning Projects
 - Machine Learning Algorithms
 - Machine Learning Examples
 - Learn Machine Learning
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Step 3: Analyze Metrics

Keyword	Search Volume	Competition
Machine Learning	High	High
Machine Learning Tutorial	High	Medium
Learn Machine Learning	Medium	Low
Machine Learning Projects	Medium	Low

Step 4: Choose Keywords

Primary Keyword

Machine Learning Tutorial

Secondary Keywords

- **Learn Machine Learning**
- **Machine Learning Projects**
- **Machine Learning Algorithms**
- **Machine Learning Basics**

This forms the basis of your content strategy.

Topic 16: Advantages of Google Keyword Planner

- **Free to use**
 - **Data from Google**
 - **Reliable keyword ideas**
 - **Search volume estimates**
 - **CPC insights**
 - **Competition analysis**
 - **Easy interface**
 - **Useful for both SEO and PPC**
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Topic 17: Limitations

- **Primarily designed for Google Ads.**
 - **Search volume may appear as ranges.**
 - **Does not provide an SEO Keyword Difficulty score.**
 - **Limited competitor analysis.**
 - **No backlink analysis.**
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Google Keyword Planner vs Google Trends

Feature	Google Keyword Planner	Google Trends
Main Purpose	Keyword research	Trend analysis
Search Volume	Yes (estimated)	No (relative interest only)
Trend Graph	Limited	Detailed
Keyword Suggestions	Yes	Limited (Related Queries/Topics)
Regional Analysis	Yes	Yes
Seasonal Trends	Basic	Excellent
Best For	Finding keywords	Understanding popularity over time

Common Mistakes

- ✗ Choosing keywords based only on high search volume.
- ✗ Ignoring search intent.
- ✗ Assuming advertiser competition equals SEO difficulty.
- ✗ Ignoring long-tail keywords.

- ✗ Targeting irrelevant keywords.
 - ✗ Not considering location and language filters.
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Best Practices

- ✓ Start with a seed keyword.
 - ✓ Use filters to match your target audience.
 - ✓ Compare multiple keyword ideas.
 - ✓ Analyze search volume, competition, CPC, and relevance together.
 - ✓ Combine Keyword Planner with Google Trends for better insights.
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Chapter Summary

Google Keyword Planner is one of the most valuable tools for keyword research.

It helps users:

- Discover new keywords.
- Estimate monthly search demand.
- Analyze advertiser competition.
- Understand CPC.
- Plan SEO and advertising strategies.
- Build keyword lists for content creation.

Although it was built for advertisers, it is also an essential tool for SEO professionals because it provides valuable insights into user search behavior.

Interview Questions

1. What is Google Keyword Planner?
2. Why was Google Keyword Planner created?
3. What are the two main features of Google Keyword Planner?
4. What is the difference between "Discover New Keywords" and "Get Search Volume and Forecasts"?

- 5. What does Search Volume represent?**
- 6. What does Competition mean in Google Keyword Planner?**
- 7. What is CPC?**
- 8. Why is CPC useful in SEO?**
- 9. Why should long-tail keywords be considered?**
- 10. How is Google Keyword Planner different from Google Trends?**